

Building What Endures: Leadership and the Long View of India's Defence Self-Reliance



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Milestones and anniversaries invite reflection, not only on what has been achieved, but on what has been built quietly, away from immediacy and noise. In India's defence sector, this distinction carries particular weight. Capability cannot be rushed, credibility cannot be improvised, and leadership is tested not by visibility but by restraint. As India advances its pursuit of strategic autonomy, the transformation of its defence ecosystem is being shaped as much by patience and discipline as by policy intent.

It is within this evolving landscape that **Vijayan Trishul Defence Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (VTDS)** has taken shape, guided by the leadership of **Mr. Sahil Luthra**, Founder and Managing Director. His entry into the defence sector is not a story of abrupt reinvention, but of deliberate alignment between personal conviction and national priority.

Raised in New Delhi, Sahil grew up around individuals connected to India's security and protection ecosystem. The values of discipline, preparedness, and service were not abstract ideas but lived experiences. While his early professional journey unfolded in land banking

and real estate through SL Investors and Developers LLP, the objective of contributing to national development remained central. As India's geopolitical environment grew more complex and the case for defence indigenisation strengthened, his focus shifted decisively toward building long-term capability in defence manufacturing.

VTDS emerged from this shift with a clear understanding of the sector's realities. Defence manufacturing is capital-intensive, highly regulated, and defined by long gestation cycles. From inception, the company has prioritised planning, regulatory alignment, research orientation, and ecosystem integration over immediate production. This measured approach reflects a conscious decision to build foundations first, recognising that premature manufacturing in the defence sector carries lasting strategic and reputational risks.

This philosophy found tangible expression when VTDS secured land in the Jhansi node of the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor. More than an infrastructure milestone, the move places the company within a government-supported ecosystem designed to strengthen indigenous defence manufacturing. Defence corridors are intended to integrate skilled manpower, logistics, policy incentives, and industrial capacity, enabling enterprises to grow in alignment with national objectives under Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat.

Integral to VTDS's direction is **Ms. Prikansha Luthra**, Co-Founder and Director. With a professional background spanning journalism and business, she brings balance to the leadership structure through a focus on governance, financial discipline, and

organisational clarity. Her role reinforces the importance of structured execution and responsible decision-making in a sector where accountability and precision are non-negotiable. Together, the leadership reflects an approach that values coherence over haste and substance over spectacle.

What distinguishes Sahil Luthra's leadership is an insistence on preparation before projection. At a time when visibility is often mistaken for progress, VTDS has chosen to strengthen internal systems, evaluate partnerships carefully, and align future capabilities with India's long-term strategic requirements. Manufacturing, the leadership maintains, must follow readiness, not precede it.

Recognition has followed this measured approach. Both Sahil and Prikansha Luthra have received acknowledgements for leadership in defence entrepreneurship, which they view not as milestones achieved but as affirmations of direction. Within VTDS, such recognition serves as encouragement to remain disciplined and focused on the larger objective of contributing to India's sovereign defence capability.

As India positions itself for a larger role in global defence manufacturing and innovation, the sector's future will depend on leaders who understand that strategic strength is cumulative. It is built through consistent choices, institutional thinking, and the willingness to prioritise national interest over short-term gain.

In that sense, the story of VTDS and of Sahil and Prikansha Luthra is less about arrival and more about intent. It reflects a leadership mindset increasingly necessary for India's next phase of growth, one focused on building what endures long after the headlines fade.